

**CENTRAL OFFICE**

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Willow Creek

CONNECTIONS**EARLY CHILDHOOD PLUS****PEP ASSIST**

To: Superintendents and Lead Special Education Administrators

From: Habeebah R. Grimes, CEO, Positive Education Program
Bob Mengerink, Superintendent, Educational Service Center of Northeast Ohio

Date: May 15, 2024

Re: PEP Contracts for 2024-25 School Year

Our shared work continues to present challenges to all of us and the workforce realities force new ways of working. PEP has always provided a longer school year, and we have learned that this calendar is impacting our ability to recruit and retain staff. For this reason, we have modified next year's calendar for four of our centers (Chesnutt, Hopewell, Phoenix, Willow Creek). PEP Prentiss Autism Center will continue to provide a year-round school year, and the days of service are unchanged.

We try hard to keep our rates as low as possible. However, workforce challenges, higher costs of goods, and the depth of needs of the young people we serve are all factors that influence our costs. Therefore, the annual costs per student will increase next year by 4% at PEP Prentiss, 5% at PEP Phoenix, and 7% at PEP Chesnutt, PEP Hopewell, and PEP Willow Creek.

With this memo, we are sending the contract for Special Education Services provided by PEP. This agreement is being sent to both the district superintendent and the district's lead special education administrator. Please sign the agreement and return to:

Beth Gould
Positive Education Program
3100 Euclid Avenue
Cleveland, Ohio 44115
bgould@pepcleve.org

Should you have any thoughts or questions, please contact Habeebah R. Grimes at 216-361-4400 ext. 123.